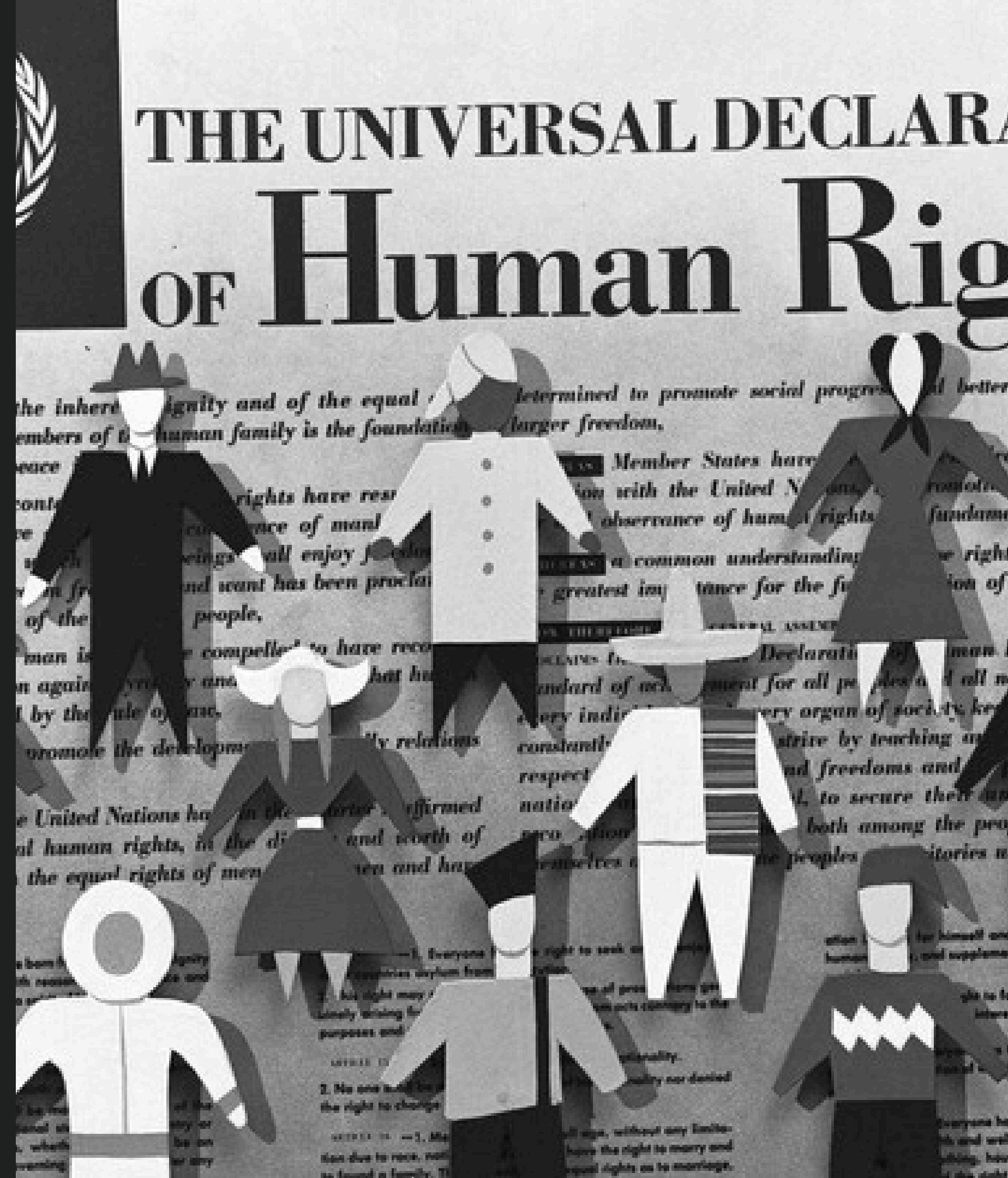


Human Rights at the core of democracy



Team Members:

Mayank Sharma / 2025BTECH155

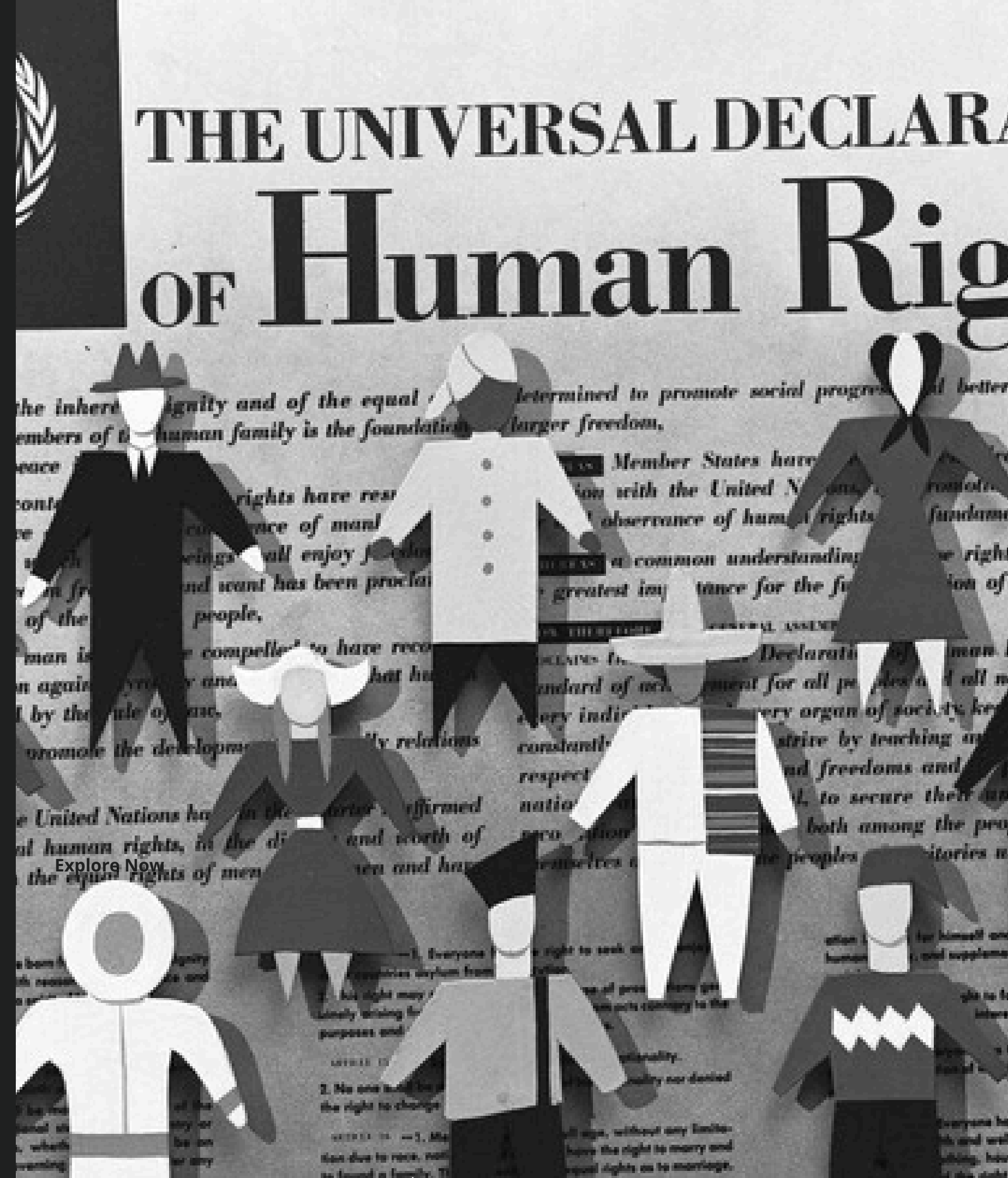
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Agreema Gauttam / 2025BTECH124



REMEMBER

- What are human rights?
- What is democracy?
- Name any two fundamental rights in a democracy.
- Who protects human rights in a country?
- What is the role of a constitution in democracy?
- **What are the core principles that define democracy and human rights?**

UNDERSTAND

- Explain the relationship between human rights and democracy.
- Why are human rights important in a democratic system?
- Describe how freedom of speech supports democracy.
- Explain the concept of rule of law in simple terms.
- How does equality promote democratic values?
- Can a democracy survive if it only protects the rights of the majority and ignores the minority?.

APPLY

1. How would you use human rights principles to solve a community conflict?
2. Give an example of applying freedom of expression in daily life.
3. How can students promote equality in schools?
4. Show how democratic rights can be used to address injustice.
5. Apply the concept of justice to a real-life situation.
6. In a democracy, a law is passed by majority vote that discriminates against a religious minority. How does this situation challenge the idea that democracy protects human rights?

ANALYZE

- Compare democracy with and without human rights protection.
- Analyze the impact of denying freedom of speech in a democracy.
- What are the causes of human rights violations?
- Examine the relationship between power and rights in governance.
- Differentiate between legal rights and moral rights.
- How does the systematic restriction of human rights structurally degrade a democracy into an autocracy, even if elections are still held?

EVALUATE

1. Do you think democracy can exist without human rights? Justify your answer.
2. Evaluate the effectiveness of laws in protecting human rights.
3. Judge whether all citizens enjoy equal rights in your country.
4. Assess the role of media in protecting democracy and human rights.
5. Critique government actions when rights are violated.
6. Which is more important: security or freedom? Defend your position.

CREATE

- Design a campaign to promote human rights awareness.
- Create a strategy to balance strong leadership (without democracy) and protection of human rights
- Propose solutions to reduce human rights violations.
- Develop a school policy to ensure equality and fairness.
- Write a speech on “Human Rights: The Foundation of Democracy.”
- Construct a framework for protecting minority rights in a democracy.

**What are the core principles that define
democracy and human rights?**

Presenter: MANVI SINGH

Bloom's Level: REMEMBER

Deconstructing the Topic

Critical Question: If democracy is only about majority rule, Can rights still be violated?

Democracy a system of government where power lies with the people through free and fair elections.

Human Rights: Basic rights that belongs to every individual .

Minority Rights: Protection given to weaker groups to prevent discrimination.

Identifying Bias & Fallacies

Optimism Bias :Believing that democracy always protects human rights, even though sometimes it doesn't.

Confirmation Bias : Only looking at examples where democracy works well, and ignoring cases where it fails.

Appeal to tradition: Saying “Democracy has always protected rights, so it always will” — which is not always true.

False Equivalence: Thinking that just because laws exist, people are actually getting those rights.

Hasty Generalization: Judging all democracies as good just by looking at a few examples.

Fact Checking

Claim 1-

Democracies never violate rights.

Verdict: FALSE

Explanation: Countries like the U.S. and India still face issues like inequality, minority discrimination.

Claim 2-

Democracy and human rights always coexist.

Verdict: Partially TRUE

Explanation: The UN and Amnesty International show that rights often erode even in democratic states if laws aren't enforced.

Ladder Of Inference

1. **Observable Data:** Democracies protect rights through laws, elections, and accountability institutions.
2. **Selected Data:** Focused on successful models
3. **Make Assumptions:** All democracies protect human rights equally.
4. **Conclusion:** Democracy needs human rights to survive.
5. **Beliefs:** Human rights are essential for true democracy, and without them, democracy becomes unfair or incomplete.
6. **Actions:** Support laws and institutions that protect rights, question unfair practices, and promote equality and accountability in society.

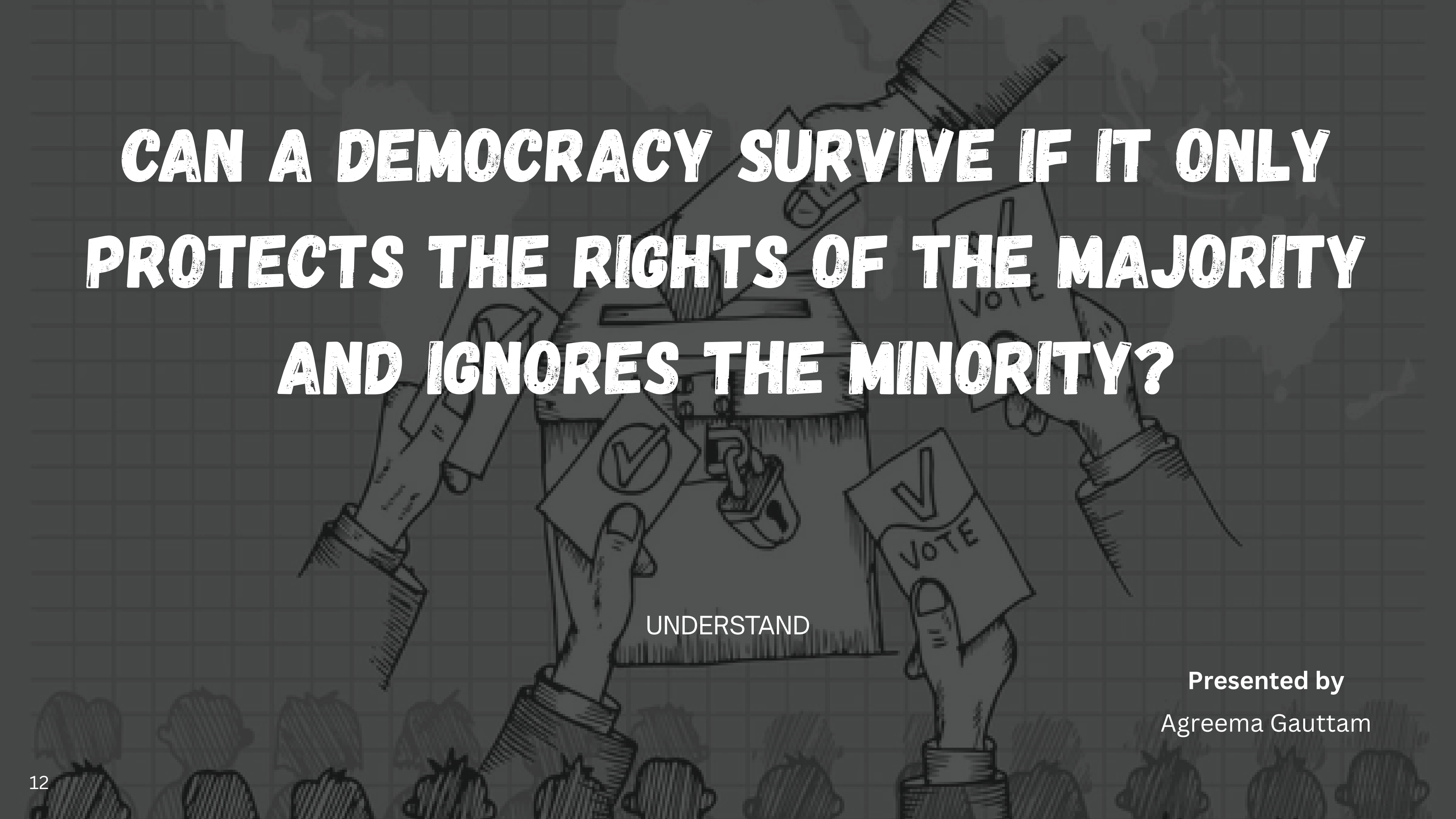
Neutrality Check: Recognized that democracy and human rights ideally go together, but violations reveal the gap between principle and practice.

Final Argument

Democracy and human rights are interdependent—neither can exist fully without the other.

- **Democracy ensures people's participation and voice.**
- **Human rights ensure people's dignity and protection.**

However, rights are not guaranteed by the label “democracy” alone—they are realized only when institutions uphold justice, liberty, and equality without bias.



CAN A DEMOCRACY SURVIVE IF IT ONLY PROTECTS THE RIGHTS OF THE MAJORITY AND IGNORES THE MINORITY?

UNDERSTAND

Presented by
Agreema Gauttam

LADDER OF INFERENCE

1. What I Actually Saw

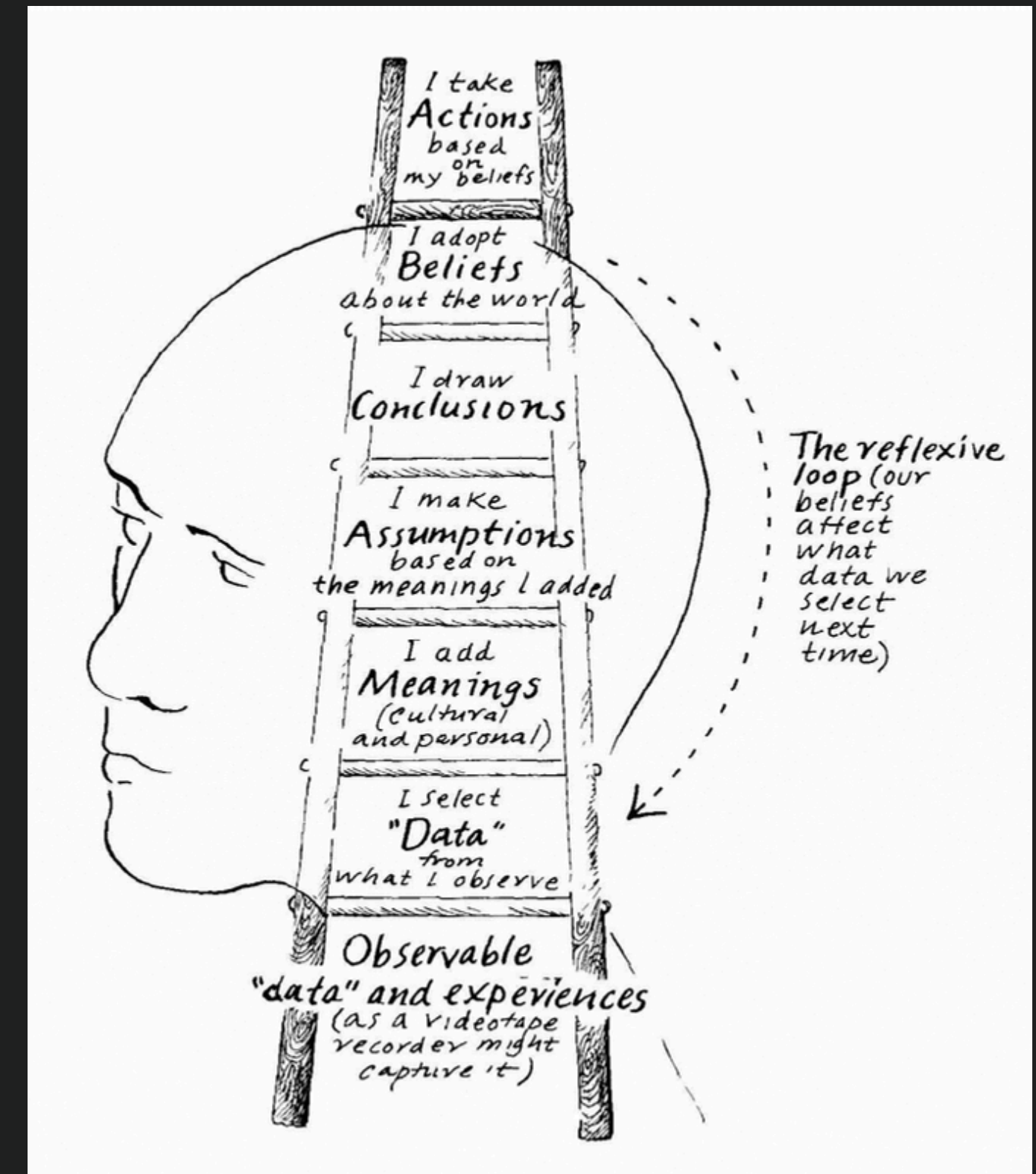
In every democracy I studied, the majority had a louder voice. Minority communities were present — but consistently overlooked in decisions that affected them the most.

2. What I Chose to Focus On

I focused only on cases where minorities were outvoted and unheard. I ignored constitutional protections that sometimes worked in their favour. I picked data that confirmed what I already felt.

3. What I Thought It Meant

To me, this meant that in a majority-only democracy, minorities are not truly protected — they are simply tolerated.



4. What I Took for Granted

I assumed being outvoted means being unprotected. I never questioned whether courts or constitutional rights could still safeguard minority rights even when votes did not.

5. The Conclusion I Reached

A democracy that ignores minority rights is not a full democracy — it is majoritarianism with a democratic label.

6. What I Started to Believe

Minority rights are not optional in a democracy. They are the test of one. A democracy that fails its minorities has failed itself.

7. What I Did with That Belief

I built my entire argument on this conviction — and while I stand by it, I now recognise I must also examine the safeguards that already exist.

COGNITIVE BIASES & LOGICAL FALLACIES

BANDWAGON EFFECT

01

People assume the majority is always right, ignoring minority perspectives.

CONFIRMATION BIAS

02

Supporting only those ideas that justify majority dominance and ignoring opposing viewpoints.

IN-GROUP BIAS

03

Favoring one's own group (majority) while neglecting or discriminating against minority groups.

FALSE DILEMMA

01

Presenting only two options: either support majority rule or lose democracy, ignoring balanced alternatives.

HASTY GENERALISATION

02

Assuming majority decisions always lead to fair outcomes without enough evidence

ARGUMENTUM AD POPULAM

03

Claiming something is right just because most people believe it.

1. Institutional Strength Matters

The issue may not be majority rule itself, but how strong the institutions (courts, media, constitution) are in protecting minorities.

2. Minority Influence Still Exists

Even if minorities are outvoted, they can still influence democracy through activism, public opinion, and legal action.

FINAL VERDICT

3. Majority is Not Always Oppressive

Assuming the majority will always harm minorities may be misleading — sometimes the majority supports and protects minority rights.

4. Democracy is a Continuous Process

Democracy is not fixed; it evolves. Even if minorities are ignored at times, systems can adapt and correct themselves over time.

****Fact 1 — Origin****

The Ladder of Inference was developed by Chris Argyris in 1970 and later popularised by Peter Senge in **The Fifth Discipline** (1990).
— Harvard Business Review, 1991

****Fact 2 — The 7 Rungs****

The model has exactly 7 steps — from observable reality to action.
— Senge, P.M. (1990). **The Fifth Discipline.** Doubleday

****Fact 3 — Minority Rights and Democracy****

The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948) Article 2 states that every person is entitled to all rights and freedoms without distinction of any kind including race, religion or national origin.
— United Nations, UDHR (1948)

****Fact 4 — Majoritarianism vs Democracy****

A democracy that only protects majority rights is classified as majoritarianism — not a full democracy. True democracy requires protection of both majority and minority rights.
— Diamond, L. (1999). **Developing Democracy: Toward Consolidation.** Johns Hopkins University Press

****Fact 5 — Reflexive Loop****

Our existing beliefs influence what data we select — creating a loop where assumptions keep reinforcing themselves without being questioned.
— Argyris, C. & Schön, D.A. (1978). **Organizational Learning.** Addison-Wesley



Ques - 3

In a democracy, a law is passed by majority vote that discriminates against a religious minority. How does this situation challenge the idea that democracy protects human rights?



Presented by - Sneh Toshniwal

Democracy Protects Human Rights? (Application)

First thought: Democracy should protect everyone, but this situation shows it may fail sometimes



Why → Majority rule can overpower minority rights

- Law passed by majority
- Religious minority is discriminated
- Shows limits of democracy

*Concept Applied:
Rule of Law & Rights
Protection*

- Democracy is not just voting
- It must include equality, justice, and protection for all

➡ **Human Rights vs Majority Rule:** conflict becomes clear in real-life situation

Question:

How does this situation challenge the idea that democracy protects human rights, and what does it suggest about the need for safeguards beyond majority rule?

Bloom's Taxonomy level: Apply

Ladder Of Interference

Observation:

A law is passed by majority votes that discriminates against a religious minority

Situation (Data):

Government bans protests for “national security”

What People Focus On:

Law passed by elected majority

Assumption:

“Elected government decisions are always democratic”

Conclusion:

Restricting protests is justified

Reality (Critical Shift):

No protest → No voice → No accountability → Weak democracy

Biases & Fallacies:

Majority Bias (Bandwagon Effect):

People assume that if most citizens support a law, it is automatically democratic.

Example: A government elected by majority passes a law limiting minority rights, and people accept it as “the will of the people,” ignoring injustice.

Anchoring Bias:

People focus only on elections as the definition of democracy and ignore other factors like rights and freedoms.

Example: Even when media is controlled or protests are banned, citizens still believe the system is democratic because elections are still held.

False Equivalence:

This occurs when one equates the mere act of "holding regular elections" with a "functioning democracy". It ignores the fact that autocracies also hold elections, which are often rigged or suppressed.

Conclusion:

I applied the concept of human rights in democracy to a real-life situation.

I showed that majority rule can sometimes lead to discrimination against minorities.

I explained that democracy is not only about voting, but also about protecting everyone's rights.

I highlighted the limits of democracy when majority power overrides minority rights.

Using the Ladder of Inference, I analyzed how people make wrong assumptions about democracy.

I identified key biases and fallacies like majority bias and false equivalence.

I showed how these biases can make people accept unfair laws as democratic.

I emphasized that rights must be protected for all, not just the majority.

Analysis:

Examining the structural relationship between majority rule and minority rights

How does the systematic restriction of human rights structurally degrade a democracy into an autocracy, even if elections are still held?

The Critical Pivot:

We often think of democracy simply as "majority rule." However, if a majority votes to strip the rights of a minority, is it still a democracy, or is it the tyranny of the majority?

The Core Argument:

Stripping human rights doesn't just harm citizens; it breaks the mechanics of democracy itself.



Defining the Core Mechanics

Electoral vs. Liberal Democracy

Electoral Democracy: The mechanical process of holding elections (majority rule).

Liberal Democracy: The structural protection of individual and minority human rights (freedom of speech, assembly, equal protection).

The Analysis:

Human rights are not just a "bonus" feature of democracy; they are the load-bearing walls. You cannot have free and fair elections without the human right to free expression, free press, and freedom of assembly.



Biases & Fallacies in Defining Democracy

Identifying our cognitive blind spots before analyzing the data:

- Bias 1: The Majority Bias (Bandwagon Effect): The assumption that whatever the majority of voters choose is inherently "democratic," even if it violates the fundamental rights of a minority.
- Bias 2: Anchoring Bias: We are anchored to the historical idea that "Democracy = Voting." Therefore, as long as people are casting ballots, we ignore the suppression of rights happening behind the scenes.
- Logical Fallacy 1: Appeal to Popularity (Argumentum ad Populum): "80% of the country voted for this law, so restricting those rights is the democratic will of the people." (Fact: A democratic process cannot be used to dismantle democratic principles).
- Logical Fallacy 2: False Equivalence: Equating "holding regular elections" with "functioning democracy," completely ignoring that autocracies also hold (rigged or suppressed) elections.

Fact-Checking Claims Using Global Data

Claim: "Restricting certain human rights (like free speech or protest) stabilizes a country and protects the majority."

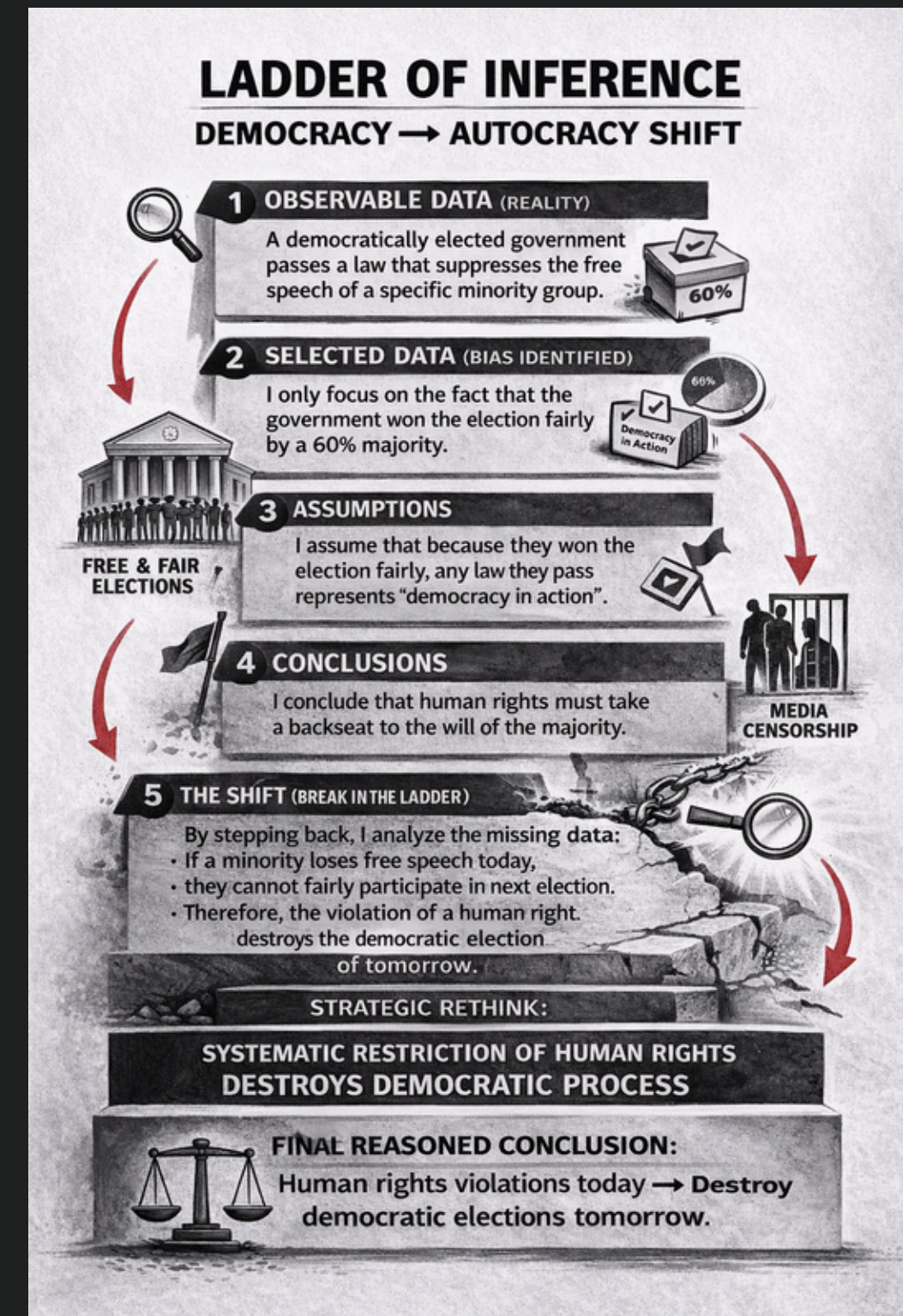
- Verdict: FALSE
- Evidence: According to the V-Dem Institute (Varieties of Democracy) 2024 report, countries that restrict civil liberties in the name of "security" experience a direct, measurable decline in institutional stability.

Claim: "You can have a functioning democracy without universal human rights."

- Verdict: PARTLY FALSE
- Evidence: You can have an Electoral Autocracy (where elections happen but rights are denied), but you cannot have a true democracy. Data from Freedom House shows that 70% of the global population now lives in countries where elections occur, but basic human rights are structurally compromised.

Tracing Our Reasoning

- **Observable Data:** A democratically elected government passes a law that suppresses the free speech of a specific minority group.
- **Selected Data:** I only focus on the fact that the government won the election fairly by a 60% majority.
- **Assumptions:** I assume that because they won the election fairly, any law they pass represents "democracy in action."
- **Conclusions:** I conclude that human rights must take a backseat to the will of the majority.
- **The Shift (Breaking the Ladder):** By stepping back, I analyze the missing data: if a minority loses free speech today, they cannot participate fairly in the next election. Therefore, the violation of a human right today destroys the democratic election of tomorrow.



Neutrality Check & Final Analyzed Conclusion

- Neutrality Check: I acknowledge the complexity: governments must balance national security with absolute individual rights.
- However, I am avoiding the bias of defining democracy solely by its popularity contests (elections).
- Final Unbiased Argument: Human rights and democracy are not two separate concepts; they are deeply intertwined mechanisms.
- Human rights (like freedom of expression, press, and equality) are the prerequisites that make democratic elections legitimate.
- Therefore, the moment a state begins to dismantle human rights, it is not merely acting "poorly" or "unjustly"—it is actively dismantling its own democratic status. Human rights are the software that allows the hardware of democracy to run.



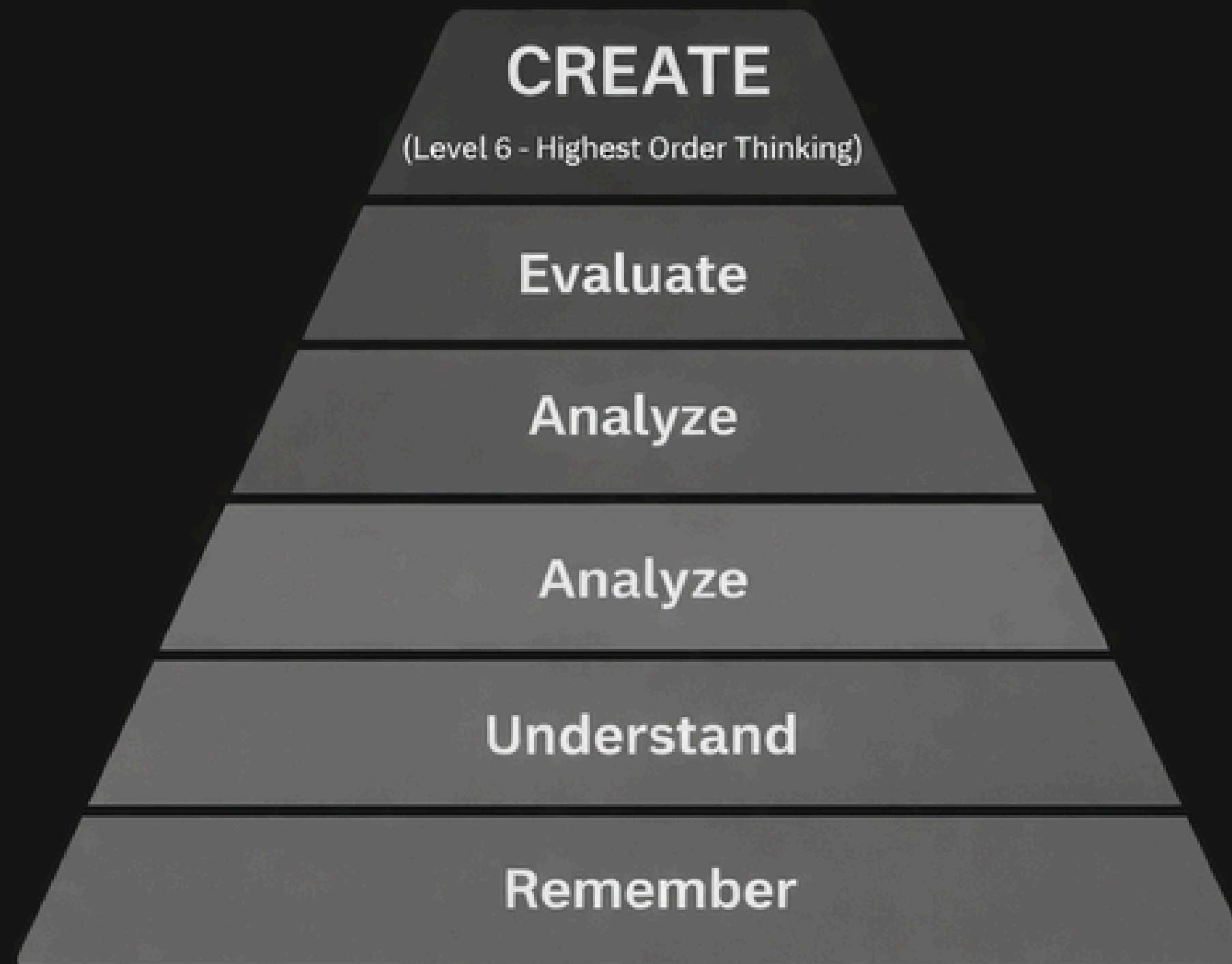
QUES 6:

**Create a strategy to balance strong leadership
(without democracy) and protection of human rights.**



PRESENTER: NOMISH AGARWAL

BLOOM TAXONOMY LEVEL



HUMAN ELEMENTS IN GOVERNANCE

Beyond Power

Shifting the focus from state authority to the lived experience of the people

The Core Tension

Navigating the delicate balance between decisive leadership and individual freedom.

Our Mission

Establishing human rights as the non-negotiable foundation of state legitimacy.

Governance is not merely a mechanism of control; it is a profound responsibility toward the dignity of every individual being governed.

BALANCING STRONG LEADERSHIP WITH HUMAN RIGHTS



WHY?

- Democracy requires both effective leadership and protection of human rights.
- The challenge is not choosing one—but balancing both

PROPOSED FRAMEWORK

- Limited but strong leadership powers
(quick decision making within clear limits)
- Non-negotiable fundamental rights
(life, dignity, fair trial always protected)
- Checks and balances
(courts, media, independent bodies)
- Transparency & accountability
(leaders answerable for actions)

SUPPORT SYSTEM

- Active citizen participation
- Free and responsible media
- Legal awareness in society

"Strong leadership serves Peoples only when it is bound by human rights."

➤ How Create:

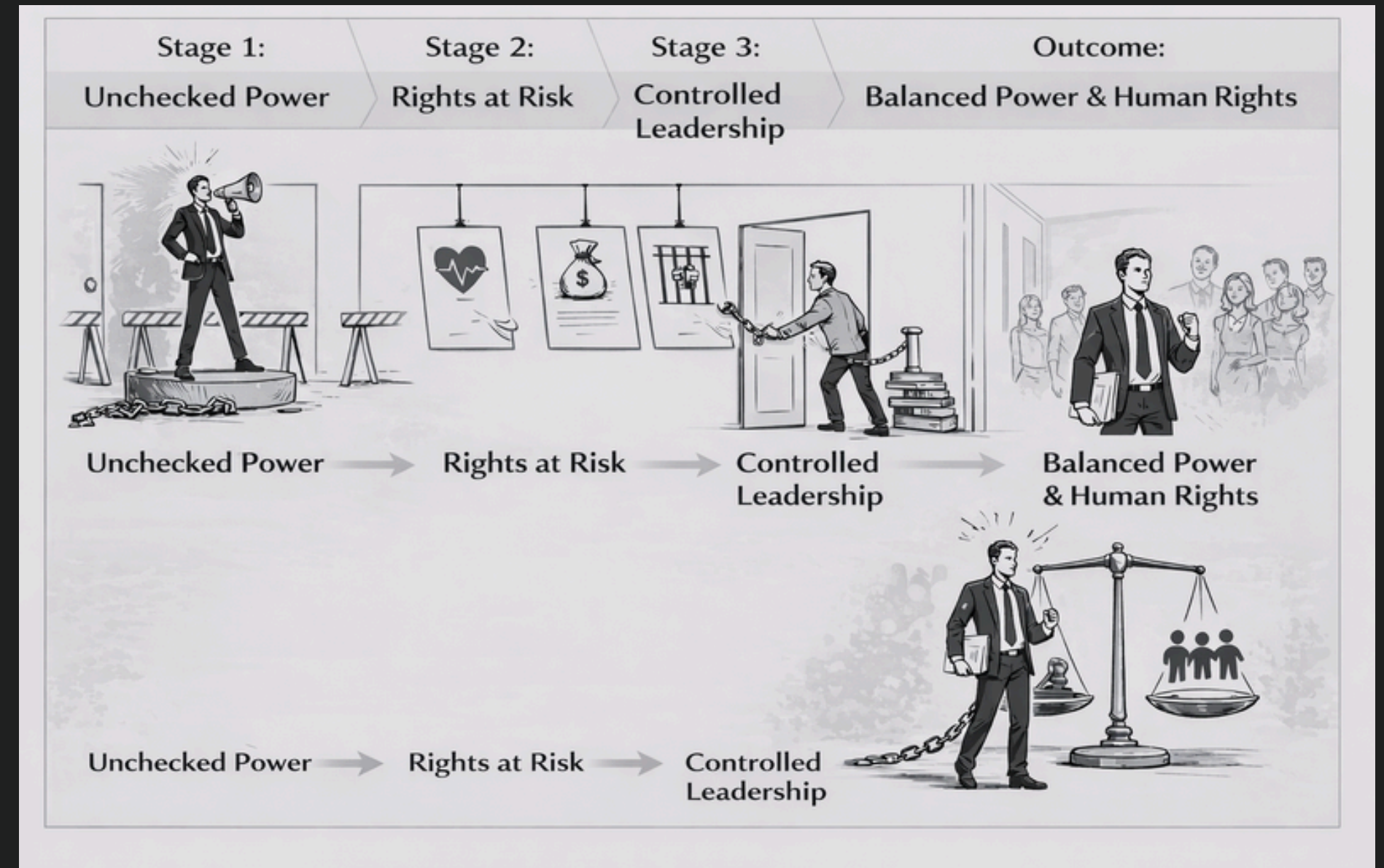
- designing a system where strong leadership operates within limits
- developing a model that ensures protection of human rights without full democracy

➤ We are also using elements of Evaluate & Analyze:

- identifying risks of unchecked power
- analyzing which rights must always be protected

➤ Expected Outcome

- balance between efficiency and justice
- prevention of authoritarian abuse
- protection of core human rights



BREAKING THE MYTH COMMON FALLICIES

FALSE CHOICE

THE MYTH

"It is either democracy OR stability—you cannot have both."

THE REALITY

True stability is not the absence of conflict, but the presence of justice and respected rights.

SLIPPREY SLOPE

THE MYTH

"If we protect all rights, the country will fall into chaos."

THE REALITY

Rights frameworks provide a release valve for social tension, preventing violent upheaval.

SOME MORE FALLICES



Red herring fallacy

A deliberate attempt to mislead and distract an audience by bringing up an unrelated issue to



Bandwagon fallacy

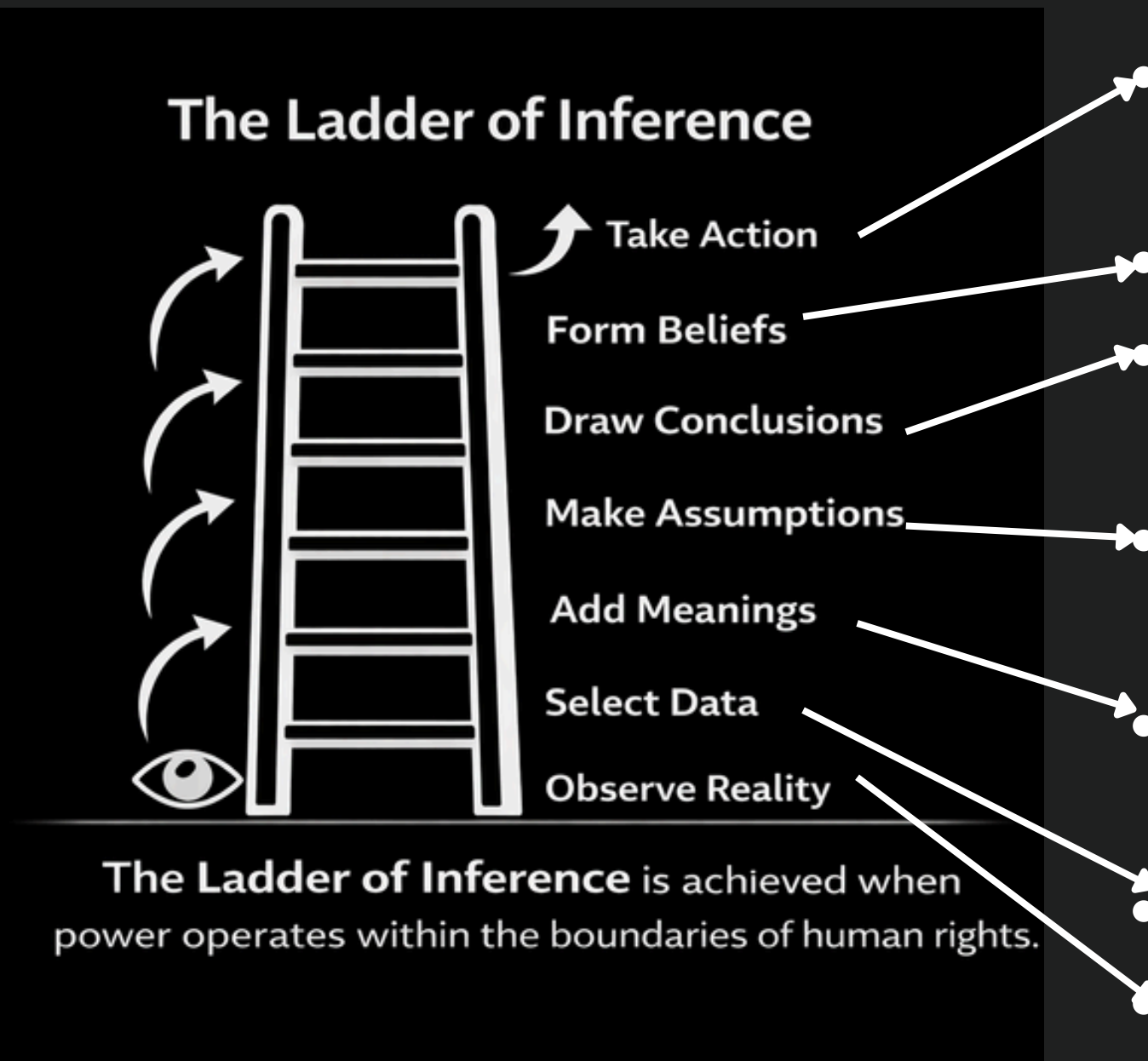
Basing the validity of our argument on how many people believe or do the same thing



Straw man fallacy

The distortion of an opponent's argument to make it easier to refute (e.g. by exaggerating or

LADDER OF INFERENCE



Suppress civil rights to "protect stability"

"Democracy is incompatible with our development
Strong leadership must override individual rights

Citizens cannot self-govern; rights cause disorder

Rights protests = threat to national security

Only incidents of unrest are noticed; peace is ignored
Actions taken at the top of the ladder often **ignore the human reality** at the bottom.

FACT CHECKING AND CLAIMS

CLAIM1

“Human rights cannot exist without full democracy.”

- VERDICT: Partially true
- Evidence: Some non-democratic systems (e.g., limited rights regimes) may protect **economic or social rights**, but **civil and political rights are often restricted**, meaning protection is incomplete.

CLAIM2

“Human rights protections weaken governance and slow decision-making.”

- Verdict: False
- Evidence: Studies indicate that **rights-based governance and public trust**, leading to more sustainable and effective decision-making over time.

CONCLUSION

KEY INSIGHTS

- Biases and fallacies shape our understanding
- The Ladder of Inference shows how assumptions distort reality

CREATE SOLUTION

- Strong leadership within limits
- Non-negotiable human rights
- Oversight and accountability

CORE ARGUMENTS

- Unchecked power leads to abuse
- Unenforced rights remain ineffective

Thank You

We appreciate Your Time